



Samsung's revolutionary 7-megapixel camera phone—the first-of-its-kind to be launched

On the audio front, the PMA400 can play MP3, WAV, WMA and DRM-protected WMA files. The PMA400 can be used as a Dictaphone using the built-in microphone. It also has a recording application that can record in MP3 and WMA in real time from most analogue devices.

The PMA400 also allows playing of Qtopia-based games and it also has Mophun game engine for playing games based on the format. You can also transfer your entire photo album can store around three lakh photographs to be viewed on its small screen.

The device is Wi-Fi ready and supports 802.11b standard. You can also connect using the Infrared and Ethernet port provided via a USB to Ethernet adapter.

You can browse the Internet using the built-in Opera browser and send and receive e-mails via the integrated e-mail client. A personal information manager lets you schedule your meetings and events just like a PDA, as the PMA 400 has a touch screen for easy data input. Since the PMA400 is based on the Linux platform you can customise it by adding new third-party applications or your own.

Archos claims a battery life of four hours for continuous video playback and nine hours for music playback. Priced at ₹800 (Rs 48,000), it's not cheap but the functionality demands it.

Samsung SCH-V770 Cell phone

A 7-megapixel camera phone! Yes that's what Samsung's SCH-V770 offers. Launched at CeBIT 2005, the SCH-V770 ushers in a new era of true digital photography convergence in cell phones.

While most cell phones today offer cameras with primitive features, the 7 mp camera on the SCH-V770 has a level of sophistication seen on standalone digital cameras with 7 mp sensor. Boasting impressive features such as 3x optical zoom and 5x digital zoom and auto-focusing, it should offer good results. The SCH-V770 can also attach to a wide-angle and tele-conversion lenses, a first for any mobile phone.

Other interesting firsts on a cell phone include the manual control of the camera. The SCH-V770 allows manual adjustment of focus, shutter speed and auto exposure lock. It also offers shutter priority, aperture priority and fully manual options for exposure control.

The display on the SCH-V770 uses a new TFD (Thin Film Diode) LCD that ensures QVGA resolution on the small display size. The screen can reproduce a breathtaking 16 million colours to give lifelike pictures.

Video-on-demand (VOD) and music-on-demand (MOD) are the other new features that are available on the V770. It also supports a TV-out function for viewing those photographs on a TV set.

For storing the pictures, the phone comes with a 32 MB MMC Micro apart from the internal memory. The set is supposed to go on sale later in the year, so stay connected.

BMW 3-Series Cars

BMW is a name that epitomises opulence and performance in cars and does not shy away from using the best available technology so they go faster, handle better and have the best safety and comfort.

The 3-Series from BMW has been a favourite among techies for its practicality and sporty character. The new 330 is packed to the gills with technology.

Under the hood, you have a magnesium and aluminium composite engine block fitted with BMW's Valvetronic ignition system that digitally controls the ignition to improve the car's power and fuel efficiency.

BMW's iDrive system is a digital interface that manages a lot of functions such as GPS navigation, Internet access, BMW Assist System in case of emergencies, climate controls and the stereo functions. The interface is operated via a knob and a small in-dash LCD display, and can also be controlled via voice commands.

Full control over the internal climate is also provided. The windshield has built-in sensors that can detect rain, mist and can automatically switch on the wipers.

The car is also equipped with radar-based cruise control and, once set, it keeps the car at a safe distance from other vehicles even in high traffic. We didn't even dare ask the price! ☒

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